

# South Florida Wedding Planning Checklist

Florida Wedding Wonders · The condensed timeline we share with couples on day one.

## 12+ months out

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- ☐ Set the date (check hurricane season risk: Jun–Nov peaks Aug–Oct)
- ☐ Lock the budget — total + per-bucket
- ☐ Draft the guest list (drives everything else)
- ☐ Tour 3–5 venues; hold a top choice
- ☐ Book photographer + planner if going full-service

## 9–12 months out

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- ☐ Send save-the-dates (especially for destination guests)
- ☐ Book caterer or confirm venue's in-house
- ☐ Book videographer, florist, DJ/band
- ☐ Reserve hotel block(s) near venue
- ☐ Buy wedding insurance (~\$200–\$500 in FL)

## 6–9 months out

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- ☐ Order the dress (allow 6+ months for alterations)
- ☐ Book hair + makeup; do a trial
- ☐ Book officiant; confirm vows + ceremony order
- ☐ Plan rehearsal dinner location
- ☐ Begin registry; share with close family only

## 3–6 months out

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- ☐ Send invitations (8 weeks before for in-state, 12 for destination)
- ☐ Order rings; allow time for resizing
- ☐ Cake tasting + design lock-in
- ☐ Apply for FL marriage license (valid 60 days)
- ☐ Lock transportation: shuttles, party bus, getaway car

## 1–3 months out

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- ☐ Final dress fitting; confirm bridal party attire
- ☐ Final headcount to caterer + venue
- ☐ Submit final timeline to all vendors
- ☐ Beach permit if outdoor (county-specific lead times)
- ☐ Confirm transportation pickups + drop-offs

## Week of

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- ☐ Confirm vendor arrival times in writing
- ☐ Pack day-of bag: emergency kit, vows, ID, rings
- ☐ Pre-tip envelopes for each vendor
- ☐ Hand off coordinator binder to planner
- ☐ Hydrate. South Florida heat is real.

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Made by the Florida Wedding Wonders team · [floridaweddingwonders.com](https://floridaweddingwonders.com)

Want help finding venues that fit this timeline? Visit </quotes/request> to get matched with up to 5 venues that fit your date, budget, and guest count.